

Professional ethics.

Unit 2 . morality and law

1. What is MORAtity and ETHICs

Morality and Ethics

✓ Morality

Morality refers to principles of **right and wrong behavior** followed by an individual or society.

It is based on values, culture, religion, and personal beliefs.

Key points

- Guides personal behavior
- Internal (comes from conscience)
- Changes with society and culture
- Example: Helping a poor person, telling truth

✓ Ethics

Ethics is the **systematic study of moral principles** that guide professional and social conduct.

Key points

- More formal and structured than morality
- Used in professions (medical ethics, business ethics, computer ethics)
- Provides rules for decision-making
- Example: Data privacy rules for IT professionals

2. Diffence between LEGAL and MORAL DUTRA

Difference Between Legal Duty and Moral Duty

✓ Legal Duty

A **legal duty** is an obligation enforced by law.
If violated → punishment by court.

Examples:

- Paying tax
- Following traffic rules
- Not committing cybercrime

✓ Moral Duty

A **moral duty** is based on conscience and social values.
No legal punishment, but social disapproval.

Examples:

- Respect elders
- Help accident victims
- Be honest

☆ Comparison

Basis	Legal Duty	Moral Duty
Enforced by	Government / Court	Conscience / Society
Punishment	Legal penalty	Social criticism
Written	Yes	No
Example	Driving license required	Helping needy person

3. What is Law (Detailed)

Law is a system of rules created and enforced by the government to regulate behavior in society.

Features of Law

- Made by authority (Parliament, Government)
- Applicable to all citizens
- Violation leads to punishment
- Maintains order and justice

Functions of Law

1. Maintains social order
2. Protects rights and property
3. Resolves disputes
4. Regulates conduct
5. Provides justice

Types of Law

- Criminal Law
- Civil Law
- Constitutional Law

4 Dissatisfaction with Law (Why Law Alone is Not Enough)

Sometimes people feel **law cannot solve all moral problems**.

Reasons:

1. Law cannot cover every situation
2. Some actions are legal but immoral
3. Law changes slowly
4. Different cultures have different moral values
5. Law cannot control thoughts and intentions

5 Philosophy (Brief Definition)

Philosophy is the study of **fundamental questions about life, knowledge, values, and reality** using logical reasoning.

It helps us understand:

- What is right or wrong
- Meaning of life
- Nature of knowledge
- Human behavior

Branches:

- Ethics
- Logic

6 Etiquette (Definition)

Etiquette means good manners and socially acceptable behavior in a particular society or profession.

Examples:

Polite speaking

Respectful communication

Professional dress code

7 Natural Law

Natural Law is the idea that certain rights and moral values are **inherent in human nature** and can be understood through reason.

Main Ideas

- Based on nature and human reason
- Universal and unchanging
- Exists even without government law
- Focuses on justice and fairness

Examples:

- Right to life
- Right to freedom

8. Short Notes

Morality

System of personal beliefs about right and wrong behavior.
It guides individual conduct and social harmony.

Law

Rules made by government to regulate society.
Ensures justice, order, and protection of rights.

Etiquette

Rules of polite behavior in society or profession.
Improves communication and personality.

Manners

Practical expression of etiquette in daily life.
Examples: Saying thank you, respecting others, punctuality.